

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Central question and the three parallel tracks

CENTRAL QUESTION -> how does one region carry energy, people and corridors at once?

ROOT CONDITION -> crude-oil import dependence of 88.2% in FY2024-25;

about 88.7% provisional in FY2025-26; Sikri's book period: approximately 70%

TRACK 1 -> GULF and ARAB WORLD: energy and diaspora

TRACK 2 -> ISRAEL: technology, defence, agriculture, innovation

TRACK 3 -> IRAN: energy history and Chabahar connectivity

DOCTRINE -> Look West, named by Tharoor as a parallel to Look East

RULE -> parallel and non-exclusive tracks, never a sequence of choices

MUST REMEMBER: West Asia policy balances energy security, diaspora welfare, remittances,...

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Two variables answers keep merging

DIVERSIFICATION -> widening the set of suppliers and equity sources

EVIDENCE: US share 4.6% -> 8.1%; UAE share 9.4% -> 11.1%, April-November FY26

ALSO ROSE: Egypt, Nigeria, Libya | DECLINED: Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Venezuela

DEPENDENCE REDUCTION -> lowering the share of consumption that must be imported

EVIDENCE: aggregate dependence remained very high across the same period

VERDICT -> diversification of sources, expressly not reduction of dependence

BRAKE -> refineries devised for the quality of crude that Iran supplies

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Energy trilemma as the evaluative frame

| SECURITY    | AFFORDABILITY      | SUSTAINABILITY            |
|-------------|--------------------|---------------------------|
| supply      | price exposure and | transition pressure and   |
| reliability | import-bill burden | long-horizon substitution |

TENSION -> a security-only frame hides trade-offs between these three limbs

APPLIED -> diversification serves security; it does not settle affordability

APPLIED -> transition pressure reshapes what security will mean over time

RULE -> evaluate the portfolio on all three axes, not on supply alone

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Israel track: depth across distinct domains

1992 -> full diplomatic relations established

JULY 2017 -> first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel

- |-- DEFENCE: procurement, counter-terrorism, co-development; Barak-8
- |-- AGRICULTURE: Indo-Israel Agricultural Project Centres of Excellence
- |-- INNOVATION: Industrial R&D and Technological Innovation Fund, 2017
- +-- MINILATERAL: I2U2 food, water, energy and technology cooperation

LIMITS -> transfer depth, cost, extension and scaling, regional conflict

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Gulf architecture with dates and forums

9 SEPTEMBER 2024, RIYADH -> India-GCC Joint Action Plan 2024-2028, adopted at the first Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue

22 APRIL 2025, JEDDAH -> second India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council

18 FEBRUARY 2025 -> India-Qatar Agreement on a Bilateral Strategic Partnership

25 JANUARY 2017 -> India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership

RULE -> name the dated instrument and its forum, never an undated partnership

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Trade instruments and their force status

INDIA-UAE CEPA -> IN FORCE since 1 May 2022

reported bilateral trade approximately USD 100 billion in FY2024-25

INDIA-OMAN CEPA -> SIGNED on 18 December 2025

entry into force requires separate verification

BOUNDARY -> tariff and trade-volume mechanics belong to the Economy owner

IR KEEPS -> the strategic-partnership significance of each instrument

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Corridor diplomacy against corridor infrastructure

9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI -> IMEC memorandum signed by eight parties:

India, US, Saudi Arabia, UAE, EU, France, Germany, Italy

-> 24 JUNE 2024: MEA India-UAE readout refers to commencement of work

-> STATUS: no completed construction or operating segment officially established

CONSEQUENCE -> connectivity diplomacy creates momentum, not delivered infrastructure

STRESS TEST -> regional conflict raises political, security and route-risk costs

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Iran track: instrument, withdrawal and disputed status

14 JULY 2015 -> Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded, Iran with E3/EU+3;  
endorsed by UN Security Council resolution 2231

8 MAY 2018 -> United States announces withdrawal; sanctions restored in stages

MAY 2019 -> Significant Reduction Exceptions end; India ceases Iranian crude purchases

13 MAY 2024 -> ten-year Chabahar contract signed

29 SEPTEMBER 2025 -> the 2018 Chabahar exception revoked with effect from this date

2025 -> after the E3 snapback action the status of restored UN measures is disputed  
by Iran, Russia and China; do not call the Plan normally functioning



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Compounding risk at one chokepoint

STRAIT OF HORMUZ -> narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman

-> ENERGY: freight, insurance and supply insecurity transmit immediately

-> DIASPORA: physical safety of a very large expatriate population is exposed

-> CONNECTIVITY: corridor and project viability is exposed at the same moment

LIMIT -> diversification does not remove common-route exposure

LIMIT -> reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk

DISTINCTIVE -> compounding rather than isolated risk, unlike most partner regions

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Diaspora exposure priced with dated evidence

SIKRI -> a diaspora of 5 million in the Gulf, period-specific

THAROOR -> the Arab world is home to nearly 6 million Indians, period-specific

MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026 -> UAE 4,344,008 | Saudi Arabia 2,750,551

STATUS -> population-stock estimates, not citizenship or OCI counts

27 JUNE 2025 -> Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 nationals:

3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel

BOUNDARY -> relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political declaration, memorandum, treaty, investment pledge, corridor...

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Balancing without contradiction

PROBLEM -> deepening Israel ties could be read as a slight by Arab partners

RESPONSE: India values Israel ties but not at the expense of Arab and Muslim friendships

PROBLEM -> a two-state position could be read as abandoning Israel cooperation

RESPONSE: recognition of the State of Palestine in 1988 runs alongside full relations

PROBLEM -> the October 2023 conflict tests both limbs at once

RESPONSE: condemn terrorism, seek humanitarian protection, hostage release, dialogue

VERDICT -> active balancing sustained by continuous effort, not a single declaration

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Use named evidence with ministry,...

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a West Asia demand

OPEN -> state the dependence baseline with its exact financial year and basis

BUILD -> energy, diaspora, technology and connectivity, each with one dated instrument

TEST -> price chokepoint exposure, sanctions transmission and unverified unilateral activity

CLOSE -> give a trilemma verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio, predicting no price or outcome